

Adjacent Possible Map

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Where the next move can realistically go

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Adjacent Possible Map identifies the set of moves realistically reachable from a firm's current position — the adjacent possibilities — guiding expansion that builds on existing capabilities.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Drawing on Stuart Kauffman's biological concept of the 'adjacent possible', applied to strategy and innovation.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to focus expansion on feasible, capability-leveraging adjacencies rather than distant, unsupported leaps.

FIGURE 1 · ADJACENT POSSIBLE MAP

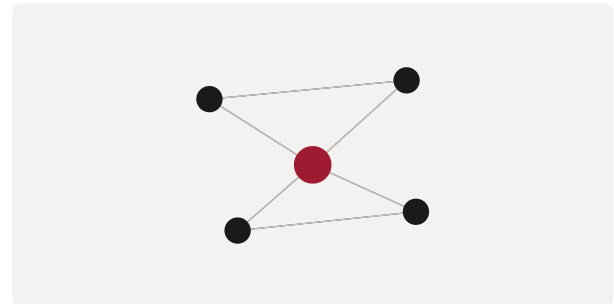


Figure 1. A schematic of the Adjacent Possible Map as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Current capabilities and assets define the reachable adjacent moves; expansion targets the most valuable feasible adjacency.

WHEN IT IS USED

When planning growth and diversification under change.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Strategy and corporate-development teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It disciplines expansion by realistic reach, balancing ambition against capability in volatile markets.

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SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Kauffman, S. (2000) Investigations. Oxford: OUP.

Johnson, S. (2010) Where Good Ideas Come From. New York: Riverhead.